

Rodrigo G. Freundt
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June 22, 2026

Hiring Committee
Smithsonian Astrophysical Observatory (SAO)
Cambridge, MA

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am writing to apply for the Electronics Engineer position (applying concurrently to both IS-0855-14 and IS-0855-13) at the Smithsonian Astrophysical Observatory. With over ten years of experience designing, deploying and maintaining state-of-the-art astronomical instrumentation, I believe I am exceptionally well suited for this role.

I am currently a Ph.D. candidate in Astronomy and Space Sciences at Cornell University. I work with Prof. Gordon Stacey and Prof. Michael Niemack on multiple aspects of Prime-Cam, a cryogenic modular receiver for the Fred Young Submillimeter Telescope (FYST). In particular, I've been focused on the development of the Epoch of Reionization Spectrometer (EoR-Spec), one of Prime-Cam's instrument modules.

I got my professional degree in Electronics Engineering from the Pontifical Catholic University of Peru, where my research focused on radio astronomy instrumentation. Before joining Cornell, I worked for two years as site engineer at the Atacama Cosmology Telescope (ACT), a cosmology experiment that was located in northern Chile.

The prospect of contributing to the SAO is genuinely exciting to me. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my background can support SAO's projects and goals.

Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,

Rodrigo G. Freundt

Notes: CV attached as a separate file; Expected completion of Ph.D. degree: Spring 2027; Authorized to work in the US for any employer.